

AI & Me: Safe, Fair, and Smart

Lesson 1: What Should I Tell an AI?

LESSON AT A GLANCE

Time: 40 minutes

Essential Question:

How much does AI need to know about me?

Big Ideas:

- AI is a tool, not a person.
- We must protect personal & secret info.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES (SWBAT)

Outcome	Evidence
Define 'personal info' vs. 'secret info' in kid-friendly terms	Quick thumbs check during mini-lesson
Classify 3-4 scenarios as safe / ask / never share	Scenario card sort (GREEN / YELLOW / RED)
Name 1 example of info they will never share with AI	Exit ticket sentence
Name 1 example of what an AI is or is not	Exit ticket sentence

MATERIALS & SETUP

Materials

- Slideshow
- Scenario cards set (12 per group)
- Scenario Cards Handouts
- Scenario Cards Answer Key
- Exit ticket slips (3 per) or Google Form

Setup

- Slideshow projected
- "Public vs. Personal vs. Secret Info" anchor chart ready
- Scenario cards printed, cut, sorted into sets
- One handout per 2-4 student group
- Exit tickets printed/cut OR Google Form in LMS

LESSON FLOW SNAPSHOT

Time	Phase	What Happens
5 min	Hook	Quick poll: "Safe or not?" on AI app asking for name, age, home address
5 min	Mini-Lesson 1	Direct teach: AI is a tool, not a person
10 min	Mini-Lesson 2	Direct teach: Public vs. personal vs. secret info
15 min	Activity	Scenario card sort in groups (GREEN / YELLOW / RED)
5 min	Exit Ticket	"1 thing I'll never share / 1 thing AI is or is not"

LESSON NOTES

- Remind students this is about tools in general, not shaming anyone's past use.
- If a student shares a real unsafe experience, thank them and pivot to safety, not blame.

SEQUENCE OF ACTIVITIES

HOOK: Custom Avatar Prompt | 0–3 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 2 — "AI Avatar Chatbot" SAY: <i>"Your friend just showed you this cool new AI Chatbot that makes custom avatars in any style you want."</i> <i>"When you get the app, before it lets you make an avatar, it asks you for your name, school, and home address."</i> <i>"Thumbs up if you think this is safe. Thumbs sideways if you're not sure. Thumbs down if it feels unsafe."</i> <i>"Turn and talk for 30 seconds explaining why you chose your answer."</i> <i>"I'm taking two answers."</i>	Thumbs vote; 2–3 students explain their thinking.	Listen for whether they mention name, age, city as "personal info" or just "it feels weird."

LESSON SETUP | 3–5 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 3 — Review Essential Question and Lesson Objectives with students.	Listen and ask questions.	Quick thumbs up to check understanding.

MINI-LESSON 1: What is AI / an LLM? | 5–10 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 4 — "What is AI?" SAY: <i>"AI is an advanced computer program that has been trained on A LOT of info — books, websites, wiki articles, and more."</i> <i>"This means it's got a lot of facts in its programming that it can give you, which makes it look smart."</i> <i>"BUT in reality, it's just guessing words based on the patterns it has trained on — just like the predictive text on your phone."</i> <i>"Which means it makes mistakes or says things that aren't true. This also means it can't think, feel, or have emotions."</i> EMPHASIZE: <i>"This is not a person. It's a computer program."</i> <i>"When you talk to it, it's basically playing the world's biggest word-guessing game: guessing the next word over and over."</i> <i>"It doesn't really understand or have feelings. It doesn't 'know you'; it just sees patterns."</i> Show slide 5 — "What is AI? Myth vs. Fact" — review with students, taking questions.	Answer yes/no; a few share ideas.	"Who thinks AI is a tool? Who thinks it's a person?"

MINI-LESSON 2: Types of Information | 10–18 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 6 — "Public / Personal / Secret Info" (Optional) On an anchor chart, write: Public / Personal / Secret. Introduce three categories with kid-friendly examples: - Public Info: Okay to share widely (first name, favorite game, age, grade, state/country). - Personal Info: For people who know you in real life only (full name, school, phone, home address, city). - Secret Info: Only share with trusted adults or family (passwords, SSN, credit cards, logins, family secrets). ASK: "What are some other examples of info you might want to or be asked to share on the internet?" Take suggestions. Help students sort them into the correct categories on the slide or anchor chart. Questions to prompt deeper thinking: - Personal Info: "What are some things you've learned not to tell strangers?" - Secret Info: "What are some things you only put securely into websites?"	Offer examples; teacher sorts them into columns.	Mis-sorted examples = quick teaching moments.

CONNECT TO AI | 18–20 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
SAY: <i>"AI and apps can remember what you type. If we type secret info into a tool, we give it away. So today we'll practice sorting what's okay to share and what needs an adult."</i>	Listen; a few students repeat key idea in their own words.	"Why is it a problem if a tool remembers secret info?"

ACTIVITY SETUP: Green / Yellow / Red Info Sort | 20–22 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 7 — "Scenario Cards Activity Directions" - Put students in groups of 2–4. - Give each group 3–4 scenario cards and a handout. - Remind rules: no writing on cards, work together. - Display the Public / Personal / Secret anchor chart while students work.	Move into groups; receive cards and handout.	Check groups have mixed colors.

ACTIVITY: Sort | 22–32 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Circulate. Prompt with questions: • "What words make you choose RED?" • "Could this ever be safe with a trusted adult?" • Note disagreements for debrief.	Read each scenario; decide which color and write the answer on the handout.	Listen for correct identification of passwords, address, secrets, images as RED.

ACTIVITY: Quick Share | 32–35 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 8 — "Scenario Cards Activity" Ask 2–3 groups: • "Which card was hardest? How did you decide?"	Share tricky examples and reasoning.	Spot misconceptions to address in exit ticket recap.

EXIT TICKET | 35–38 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 9 — "Wrap Up — Exit Ticket" Hand out exit tickets (or direct students to Google Form). Read aloud: 1. Name 1 example of info they will never share with AI. 2. Name 1 example of what an AI is or is not.	Write 1–2 short sentences.	Collect & scan: look for clear "secret info" vs. generic.

WRAP UP | 38–40 min

Teacher Actions / Script	Student Actions	CFU
Show slide 10 — "Wrap Up — Essential Question" Restate essential question: "How much does AI need to know about me?" Ask 1–2 volunteers for a short answer.	Volunteers share short answers.	Quick check: do they frame AI as a tool + mention "secret/personal info"?
Show slide 11 — "Wrap Up — Our Rule" "We protect personal and secret info, always."		

ANTICIPATED MISCONCEPTIONS & TEACHER MOVES

Likely Misconception	Teacher Move
"It's okay if I just share it once" (students underestimate persistence of data).	Re-anchor: "Tools can remember and be copied; we don't control where the info goes."
"It's fine if an app asks for my school password - it's school-related."	Hard rule: "Never type a password into a chat or random website, only the official login page for the account."
"Secrets about feelings are okay because they're not like addresses."	Validate feelings, but redirect: "If it's private or embarrassing, share it with a trusted adult, not a tool."

DIFFERENTIATION & EXTENSIONS

Type	Strategy
Emergent Bilingual / Reading Struggle	- Underline or highlight key words on cards (e.g., name, address, password). - Add simple icons, pictures, or emojis. - Pre-teach unfamiliar vocabulary (e.g., AI, personal, private, secret). - Allow verbal responses to exit tickets (teacher scribes).
Behavior	- Assign roles in groups (Reader, Decider, Recorder). - Decide on groups ahead of time based on student needs, behavior, and ability.

EXTENSIONS / ADVANCED

EARLY FINISHERS

- Create a new scenario card and label it GREEN / YELLOW / RED with rationale.
- Rewrite 1 unsafe prompt into a safe version.
- Map scenario cards to public / personal / secret categories explicitly.

REFLECTION / NOTES

Which scenario caused the most disagreement? Why?	
Did most students correctly name something they would "never share" on the exit ticket?	
One adjustment for next time:	